

Cooperant Learning – New Episode Publishing SOP (Admin Handoff)

Standard operating procedure for creating and publishing a new episode (course + quiz + product + episode post)

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1. Purpose

This document explains, step by step, how to publish a new Cooperant Learning episode from the WordPress admin side. It is written so a new site administrator (even without prior context) can reliably create the episode course, quiz, WooCommerce product, and the public episode listing/post, and verify the end-to-end experience.

2. What you are creating (high-level)

- **A WooCommerce product** (the item users purchase to unlock the episode).
- **A LearnDash course** (the episode learning experience; also drives certificates and completion).
- **A LearnDash quiz** (required for completion and CEU credit, if applicable).
- **A WordPress episode post/page** (the public listing card and/or episode detail page used for marketing and navigation).
- **ACF metadata** (guest, instructor, runtime, product ID, etc., used across cards, pages, and certificates).

IMPORTANT: On this site, each episode is tied to a unique WooCommerce Product ID and a LearnDash course. The product ID is what enables purchase/unlock logic across the UI.

3. Access and prerequisites

You will need:

- WordPress admin access (Administrator or an Editor role with LearnDash + WooCommerce permissions).

- Access to the episode assets: title, description, guest details, headshots, episode artwork, audio/video embed link, transcript (if provided), CEU details, and quiz questions/answers.
- Decision on pricing and visibility (public listing vs members only, launch date/time, any coupons).

4. Assets checklist (collect before you start)

- Episode number and final title
- Guest name(s), credentials, organization, and short bio
- Guest headshot(s) (recommended: square, at least 800x800)
- Episode artwork / cover image (recommended: 16:9 and square variants if available)
- Audio or video source (upload file OR a host embed URL)
- Episode summary + learning objectives (2–5 bullets)
- CEU credit details (hours/credits, accrediting language if required)
- Quiz bank: questions, options, correct answers, and passing threshold
- Any downloads (PDF handouts, resources)
- Launch date and price

TIP: If you do not have all quiz questions yet, do not publish the course. Create everything in draft first, then publish after quiz is complete and reviewed.

5. End-to-end workflow overview

1. Create (or duplicate) the WooCommerce product and note its Product ID.
2. Create (or duplicate) the LearnDash course for the episode.
3. Create lessons/topics (if your course template uses them) and add the media player/transcript.
4. Create the LearnDash quiz and attach it to the course.
5. Create the episode post/page and fill required ACF fields (including the Product ID).
6. QA test the full flow: logged out → purchase → unlock → course consumption → quiz → completion/certificate.
7. Publish and do a final public-facing spot check.

6. Step-by-step instructions

6.1 Create the WooCommerce product (Episode purchase item)

In WordPress admin: WooCommerce → Products → Add New.

Fill out the following fields:

Field	What to do
Product name	Use the episode title; include episode number if you use it elsewhere (example: “Episode 12 – [Title]”).
Product type	Simple product (unless your site uses a different setup).
Price	Set Regular price (and Sale price if needed).
Product image	Use the episode artwork (consistent size with other products).
Short description	1–2 sentences used in compact views (optional but recommended).
Catalog visibility	Shop and search (typical). Set Hidden only if intentionally not discoverable.

Save as Draft, then click Publish when ready.

After saving, capture the Product ID:

- 1) In the Products list, hover the product and look for “ID: #####” in the row actions, OR
- 2) Open the product edit screen and read the ID from the browser URL (post=#####).

IMPORTANT: You will paste this numeric Product ID into the episode’s ACF field(s) later. If the Product ID is wrong, purchase/unlock behavior will break.

6.2 Create the LearnDash course (Episode learning container)

In WordPress admin: LearnDash LMS → Courses → Add New.

Recommended approach: duplicate an existing episode course that already works, then update content. This preserves correct settings.

Course fields to verify

- Course title matches the episode title
- Featured image set
- Course status: Draft while building; Publish only after QA
- Course content includes: episode summary, learning objectives, guest details, and media player location (or link to where the media is embedded)
- Certificate settings (if used): ensure the certificate is attached and configured
- Course completion settings: ensure the quiz/lessons required are correct

IMPORTANT: Certificate date: the certificate uses the course Published Date as the event/date value. Do not publish until the date is correct for the certificate you intend to issue.